



■ **SCAMS**

AI Voice cloning could be scammers' next big tool

As technology is getting advanced, so are the scams around us. Whenever we are online, we have to be very careful owing to the fact that one miscalculation or mistake can lead to a big scam which can cost us a lot of money too. With the onset of AI, these scammers have found a new tool at their disposal to con innocent people.

Now, these scammers have found a new way to con you out of your hard-earned money. As I said, AI has been a big helping hand for these scammers. Have you heard of deep fakes or voice clones? I am sure you must have heard of them as people have been raising concerns all over the internet about people imitating someone else. Remember the Rashmika Mandana

case? That was a deepfake. Scammers are now using voice clones. These voice clones are super easy to generate and require only three seconds of audio input. You cannot easily differentiate between these clones and the actual voice. The con artists are using genuine AI startups such as ElevenLabs, Speechify, Respeecher, Narakeet, Murf.ai, Lovo.ai, and Play.ht as their modus operandi to create voice clones.

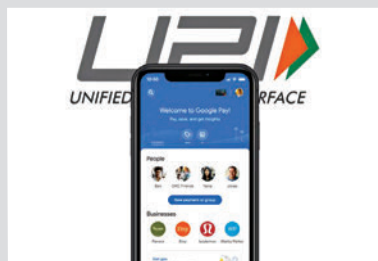
To create a voice clone, these scammers just need a sample audio of a person and then they use AI to create a synthetic audio. As far as the source audio is concerned, scammers can easily get their hands on it from Instagram, YouTube, or any other social media platform, or even from a small conversation over the phone.

Speaking about the same, Jaspreet Bindra, founder of Tech Whisperer said, "Deepfakes in general are quite dangerous, and particularly voice AI shall soon evolve into an organised phishing tool. For instance, job scams will now convert from a WhatsApp message to an actual HR voice calling you," as reported by the Economic Times.

A recent McAfee survey revealed that 47% of Indians have experienced or know someone who has experienced the AI voice scam. 83% of Indians said that they lost money to such scams. <https://bit.ly/47oXaud>

■ **UPI**

UPI to see two major changes



With the change in year, also come changes to the UPI interface that we use. A few key changes are planned with UPI for the new year that you should know of. The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has issued a circular asking digital payment providers to deactivate UPI IDs that have not used their UPI IDs for over a year. Now, the inactive UPI ID users have time until 31st December 2023 to complete their UPI IDs and activate them or else they will get deleted. <https://bit.ly/48ExXNi>